Hope Hospital		
		Guidelines on Who Can Prescribe Medications
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1. Purpose

To ensure that medication prescribing is performed only by authorized and competent personnel to maintain patient safety and comply with NABH accreditation requirements.

2. Scope

Applicable to all healthcare professionals involved in prescribing medications within the hospital or healthcare facility.

3. Authorized Prescribers

- **Registered Medical Practitioners (RMPs):**
  Physicians registered with the Medical Council of India (or respective state medical council) and holding a valid license to practice medicine.

- **Dental Surgeons:**
  Registered dental practitioners authorized to prescribe medications related to dental care.

- **Qualified Specialists and Consultants:**
  Prescribing within their specialty area.

- **Residents and Interns:**
  May prescribe medications only under direct supervision of an authorized prescriber, as per hospital policy.

- **Nurses and Allied Health Professionals:**
  NABH does **not** generally authorize nurses or allied health professionals to independently prescribe medications, except in specific contexts where legally permitted and defined by hospital policies and local laws.

4. Prescribing Authority

- Only authorized prescribers can issue medication orders.
- Prescriptions must include the prescriber's name, designation, registration number, and signature.
- Verbal orders should be given only by authorized prescribers and must be documented and authenticated promptly.

5. Restrictions

- Prescribing controlled substances and high-risk medications must comply with additional regulatory and institutional controls.
- Delegation of prescribing authority is not permitted unless explicitly allowed by law and hospital policy.

6. Compliance and Monitoring

- The hospital must maintain updated records of authorized prescribers.
- Periodic audits to verify compliance with prescribing guidelines as part of NABH's patient safety and medication management standards.